

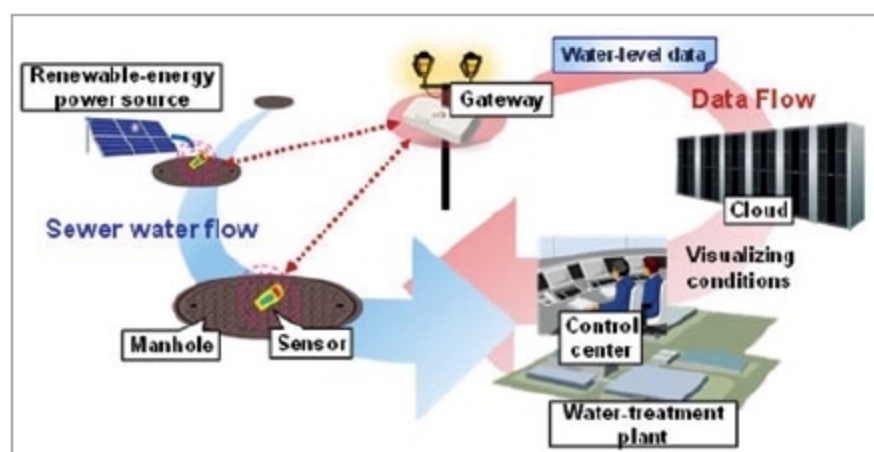


Fig. 4: How the IoT monitors sewage flow (Credit: Fujitsu.com)

ulate indoor air and keep a tab on indoor conditions.

In-car IoT devices help reduce fuel wastage—a major source of high carbon emission in urban areas.

Automated water taps and water pumps help reduce water wastage.

Challenges today and the way forward

There are many factors that play into the consistent lack of environmental well-being, a major reason being lack of awareness among citizens. Collections of wastes outside waste collection

enterprises and administrative bodies should start taking the onus to drive the motion—fortunately, they are.

Samantaray says, “In India, you do not find many monitoring stations. However, cities are gradually coming up with such stations by carefully planning the same to measure all quality parameters of the environment.”

He explains, “IoT devices themselves cannot reduce pollution all the time. These provide critical data based on which awareness must be spread and steps taken. Teaching people the benefits of renewable energy solutions

bins, overflowing sewages, malpractice in water bodies, unregulated use of fuel-based vehicles, unmonitored solid and fluid emissions from factories and much more, collectively result in these situations. While educating the

citizens is crucial,

like solar solutions, aggressively promoting plantation and afforestation, creating an ecosystem for electric vehicles and so on can help promote a healthy environment.”

Singh concurs, “We are at an early age of deploying technology for environmental benefits. A lot is yet to be done in terms of deploying air and water monitoring at large scale, smart mobility and so on. We are just touching the tip of the iceberg.”

All cities and regions need to address these problems at local levels, believes Mathur. State governments and the central government must play dedicated roles in the process.

Samantaray says that, with a large number of startups coming up with innovative solutions, data and devices can turn out to be a big opportunity in this aspect. The government has also come on board to bring in devices and apply norms, which people have started adopting slowly. “Hopefully, in two to five years, these technologies will be adopted at the fullest,” he concludes. **EFY**

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